



Batch: 2023

OS ASSIGNMENT

NAME: Fatima Shahid

ROLL NO: CS-23007

COURSE: Operating Systems (CS-329)

SUBMITTED TO: Dr. Urooj Ainuddin

QUESTION :

Explain a societal issue linked to operating systems. Analyze its causes and stakeholders. Evaluate its societal impact. Propose recommendations for solution.

Pick one of the following issues as your topic:

1. Privacy concerns in Windows 11
2. Mobile OS surveillance in Android
3. Automatic updates in Windows 11
4. Advertising in Android

ANSWER:

Privacy Concerns in Windows 11

Introduction of the Problem

With the release of Windows 11 by Microsoft, privacy concerns have become a significant societal issue. Windows 11 collects diagnostic data, usage patterns, and device information to enhance performance, improve security, and personalize user experience. However, many users argue that data collection is enabled by default and that privacy settings are not always fully transparent. This raises concerns about informed consent and the ethical handling of personal data in modern operating systems.

Personal data we collect

Microsoft collects data from you, through our interactions with you and through our products. You provide some of this data directly, and we get some of it by collecting data about your interactions, use, and experiences with our products. The data we collect depends on the

ask you to provide personal data, you can decline. Many of our products require some personal data to provide you with a service. If you choose not to provide data -required to provide you with a product or feature, you cannot use that product or feature. Likewise, where we need to

Source : <https://www.microsoft.com/en-us/privacy/privacystatement?>

Hence, users get no choice but to accept the deal in order to use the product, which is a need.

But, this site claims that your data isn't in your control. The Microsoft holds your data more than you and more than you agree to give.

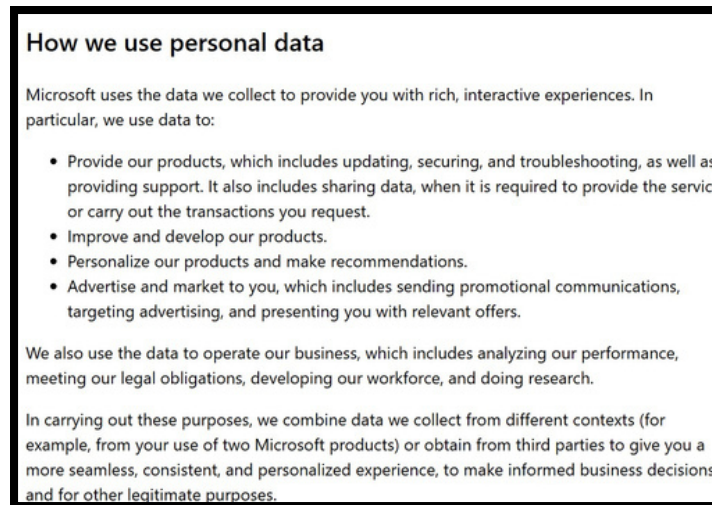
Managed collection is the real default

If I didn't know better, I would think this level of complexity is intentional.

Windows 11 makes it feel like you're in control, but behind the scenes, data collection is still deeply built into the system. The default isn't minimal data gathering. It's controlled data gathering. And that's the real problem.

Source :

<https://tech.yahoo.com/cybersecurity/articles/said-windows-11-needs-privacy-191241100.html>



Source : <https://www.microsoft.com/en-us/privacy/privacystatement?>

Causes

The issue arises primarily from the data-driven business model adopted by technology companies. Data analytics help improve system performance and artificial intelligence capabilities. Additionally, Windows 11 integrates cloud services such as OneDrive and Microsoft accounts, encouraging centralized data storage. Default privacy settings and complex policy agreements further contribute to user unawareness. Limited digital literacy also prevents users from fully understanding how their data is being processed.

Stakeholders

The primary stakeholders include individual users whose personal data is collected. Microsoft, as the developer, is responsible for designing and managing data policies. Governments and regulatory bodies are stakeholders because they must enforce data protection laws. Businesses that use Windows 11 are also affected, as employee and client data must remain secure.

Impact

Privacy concerns reduce public trust in technology. There is also an increased risk of data breaches due to large-scale data storage. Furthermore, digital inequality emerges, as only

technically knowledgeable users can properly manage privacy settings. On a broader level, the issue raises ethical debates about corporate responsibility and digital rights.

User Criticism from Forums and Comments

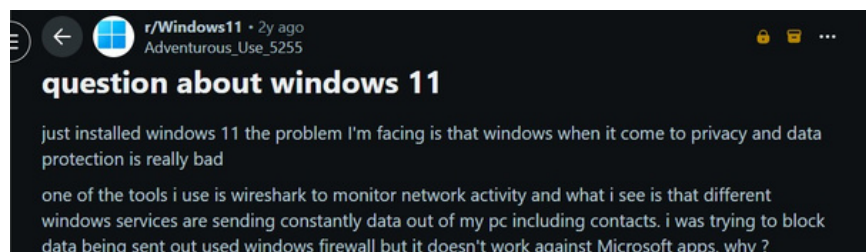
1. Users on the official Microsoft community forum expressed strong dissatisfaction with Windows 11 due to privacy concerns, loss of control, and data collection:

Many Microsoft users are expressing strong dissatisfaction with Windows 11, highlighting concerns over privacy, forced updates, and increased system monitoring. A growing number of users feel that the new

Source :

<https://techcommunity.microsoft.com/discussions/windows11/500-million-microsoft-users-say-no-to-windows-11/4475155?>

2. On Reddit, users complained about Windows 11's privacy and data protection, saying:



Source :

https://www.reddit.com/r/Windows11/comments/18jpi56/question_about_windows_11/?

Solution

To address these concerns, Microsoft should adopt clearer transparency practices and simplify privacy controls. Data collection should be based on opt-in consent rather than automatic activation. Governments should strengthen regulatory frameworks, and digital literacy programs should educate users about managing privacy settings effectively. Independent audits can also ensure accountability.